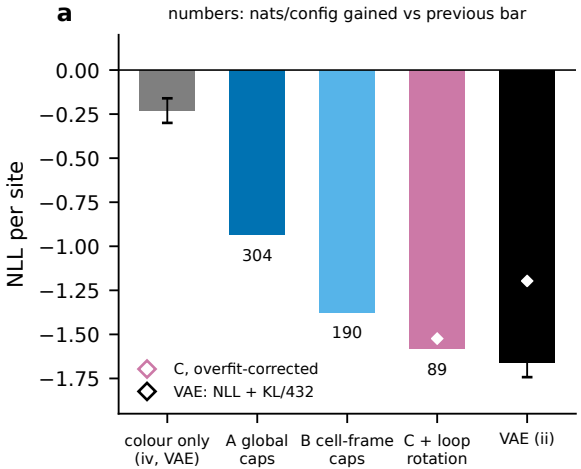
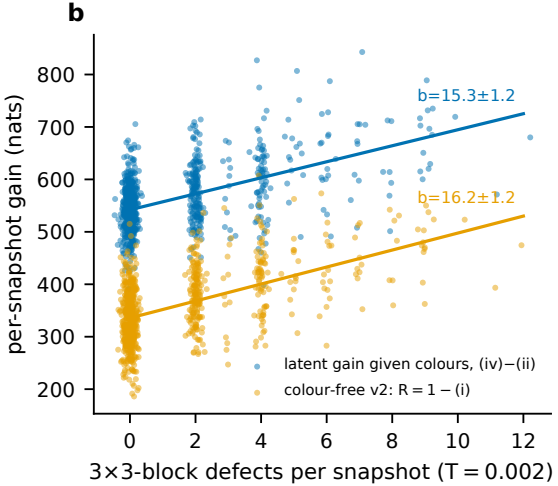
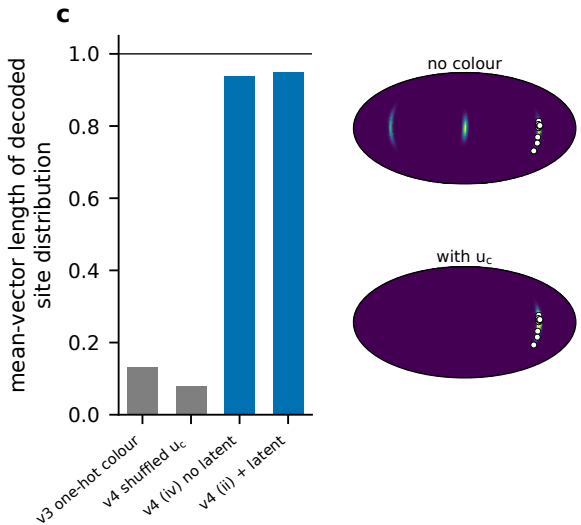






d

channel	information G	captured by VAE?
colouring (3-colour pattern)	≤ ln 3 per site (conditioning input)	only via gauge-free input u_c (v4)
global plane + triad (A)	304 nats/cfg	yes (R = 1, l = 3 latent)
local frame (B)	190 nats/cfg (~12 per 3x3 cell)	partly; not isolated
loop rotation (C)	~1.4 nats/loop	not resolved (a = 0.16 ± 0.04)
phase defects	~15–23 nats/defect	yes (b > 0 in all models)
gauge bits (time reversal, triad branch)	G ≤ ln 2	not encoded (below cost)